

THE NOHO RAG EPISODE 201

Written by

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INT. NOHO STUDIOS - DAY

Artisinal shots of the gear:

Coiled XLR cables.

DANE (V.O.)
Have you tried Salsa and Beer?

KELLY MAE (V.O.)
Individually? Yes.

Artsy shots of the light umbrellas.

DANE (V.O.)
No! The new joint on Sherman way!

KELLY MAE (V.O.)
They told me not to go north of
Victory.

Close up of someone putting on a lav.

DANE (V.O.)
Well, you're missing some great
spicy Hispanic American faire,
Kelly.
(beat)
Damn shame.

KELLY MAE (V.O.)
I'll live.

Wiping down the clapboard.

DANE (V.O.)
Of course, I got the worst squirts
of my life almost instantly.

KELLY MAE (V.O.)
Of course.

Close up of scrolling through text.

DANE (V.O.)
Yeah, I really don't think it's
fair to pay for food I don't
actually leave the restaurant with.

Dane taps his script on the desk.

KELLY MAE (V.O.)
Gross, Dane!
(beat)
Jesus.

Bob stands next to the camera.

BOB
Alright everybody, calm on the set,
stick to the script, everybody wins
in three...
(beat)
Two...

CUT TO:

NOHO TITLE CARD

CUT TO:

INT. NOHO STUDIOS

KELLY MAE
Good evening. I'm Kelly Mae
Greenblatt.

DANE
And I'm Dane Argyle.
(beat)
Santa Clause!
(beat)
Do you really know him?
(beat)
Because tonight, we have the NoHo
Rag exclusive-
(beat)
Interview.
(beat)
With.
(beat)
Santa.
(beat)
Roll it!

Bob is smacked by Dane's enthusiasm.

BOB
Oh Jesus...
(into headset)
Uh. r, roll it.

INT. SANTA'S PACKAGE INTERVIEW

Shot in the LIVING ROOM with chairs in middle of room, with the 50mm lens.

Santa sits with a tumbler of milk and pours a little bottle of brandy into his glass.

Dane Argyle sits across straightening his suit.

DANE

Ok, you can't see how gassy I am right?

(beat)

Bob?

Santa takes a sip.

SANTA

Just let it out boy.

Dane acknowledges Santa and begins the interview.

DANE

Mister Claus, thank you for meeting with us today.

SANTA

Like I have a choice.

DANE

You've come under recent scrutiny for your cookie line.

(beat)

Santa's Secret Wafers.

With a wink to camera, Santa:

SANTA

No cookies are fresher!

DANE

The commercial in particular.

SANTA

A gem!

Dane points to the ceiling.

DANE

I believe we have a clip.

INT. SANTA'S SECRET WAFERS COMMERCIAL

Santa sits in front of a brick fireplace.

SANTA

Hello children, you want help
getting off the naughty list!

(beat)

Well, Santa's got a little
something for your taste buds!

Santa reaches into the box and

Switch to 50mm.

Santa holds the walnut cookie at an angle so it looks like a
vagina. He scoops it slowly through whipped cream with his
face donning a creepy smile blurry in the back.

SANTA (CONT'D)

Santa loves a creamy cookie.

Santa winks to camera.

CUT TO:

TITLE CARD SHOT SELLING THE COOKIES

A plate with cookies and hot cocoa with a heaping amount of
whipped cream overflowing the side.

Santa reaches in a places a half-eaten cookie back on the
table.

SANTA (V.O.)

Can you keep our little secret?

CUT TO:

INT. SANTA'S PACKAGE INTERVIEW

Dane stares down Santa, saying nothing.

SANTA

Some lines may have been crossed.

CUT TO:

EXT. DANE ARGYLE'S PACKAGE

Dane sitting on a park bench.

DANE (V.O.)
 He admitted wrong doing.
 (beat)
 Score one for Dane.
 (beat)
 But something still-

Dane swats furiously at a fly.
 (beat)
 Felt.
 (beat)
 Off.

INT. SANTA'S PACKAGE INTERVIEW

Dane revs up for the big question.

DANE
 As far questions go.
 (beat)
 There's just one.
 (beat)
 Mor-

CUT TO:

BREAKING NEWS GRAPHIC

BREAKING NEWS - AT THE DESK

Kelly Mae sits tall while Dane looks disappointed. Cut to one shot of Kelly Mae.

KELLY MAE
 This just in. The NoHo Comptroller
 is about to give a surprise press
 conference. We will join them live
 momentarily.

Back to two-shot:

DANE
 That's controller, Kelly Mae.

KELLY MAE
 Nope. No it isn't.

DANE
 I have three of them for my Sega
 Genesis.

KELLY MAE
Dane, that's enough.
(beat)
And now we go live to the press
conference!

CUT TO:

INT. PRESS BRIEFING ROOM

WILSON DiNAPOLI whistles as he nearly skips to the podium.
With a content grin, he waves the crowd silent. Flashes light
his HORN RIMMED GLASSES.

WILSON
People of NoHo!
(beat)
I'm out!
(beat)
I have faithfully served as your
comptroller for 26 years, and I
have got to say...
(incredulous)
Y'all do not know how to keep a
budge-et!

Gasps from the peanut gallery.

WILSON (CONT'D)
I keep forecasting that we'll
maintain a budget surplus.
(beat)
But every time y'all.
(beat)
Every time.
(beat)
You've failed me.
(beat)
So now you may all go to hell, and
I will go to San Pedro, where I
will be starting my own business
selling Orange Juice to thirsty
dock workers.

Wilson flips two birds and motors.

INT. NOHO STUDIOS

Dane and Kelly Mae sit mouth agape. Bob stands mouth agape.

Bob snaps into action:

BOB
(sotto)
Just adlib.
(beat)
Adlib!
(beat)
Adlib!

Bob gets frustrated.

BOB (CONT'D)
Freaking adlib!

Dane acknowledges Bob, then turns to Kelly Mae.

DANE
Well, did you see that curtain?
(beat)
What was that, velvet?

Kelly Mae drops her head into her hands.

KELLY MAE
God...

Kelly Mae gets frustrated.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
You convinced me to come out here,
Dane!
(beat)
Big Hollywood news, you said.
(beat)
This city is screwed, Dane!

Bob freaks.

BOB
Just wrap it up!

As he wrings his script.

DANE
For all of us here in NoHo, good
luck, and good evening.

Kelly Mae drops her head quickly.

KELLY MAE
(sotto)
Jesus, Dane.

She regains composure all in one quick motion and focuses on the camera.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)

And I'm Kelly Mae

(beat)

Greenblatt.

(beat)

You.

(beat)

Y'all have a good night.

Bob stands by the camera. Hand on hip, rubbing head.
Facepalm.

BOB

Well.

(beat)

At least there was no nudity.

END.